

Corporate speak

HP, a leader in the printer and MFD market, feels the inkjet market is confined to professionals like lawyers, CAs, and other small businesses. "Although the initial cost maybe a little high, the cost per page comes down in the long run," says Rajiv Rao, market development manager, personal printing, imaging and printing group, Hewlett-Packard India.

Samir Shah, country category manager, shared printing and connectivity, imaging and printing group, Hewlett-Packard India says, "Today electronic transfer is the norm in most offices. So there is less of printing and more of copying. Nevertheless there is still demand and it is driven by the customer more than anybody else. We have introduced a new function in our MFDs known as "Digital Sending" that enables a printed document to be sent as an email just like you would send a fax."

"The percentage of growth in MFDs, in 2005, would be higher than that of the single-function devices." Prices of regular MFDs range between Rs 19,000 and Rs 1 lakh or more.

Lexmark, another market leader, offers features like scan-to-mail, desktop faxing, confidential printing, and LDAP access. "MFDs are certainly the future and with the total cost of ownership becoming a focus for most of the enterprises, MFDs can be looked at addressing this concern," says P G Kamath, general manager, Lexmark India.

Samsung's Vikram Singh Negi, country product manager, multifunction printers, claims that Samsung will, "produce small, faster, better MFDs this year with features such as Direct USB printing and scanning which will eliminate the need for a PC interface. Duplex Automatic Document Feeder features for double-sided copying to be intro-



Buying Tips

- ✓ Based on your usage pattern decide upon the type of warranty on offer
- ✓ Look for ease of use of the features offered
- ✓ An MFD should offer a handy interface
- ✓ Look for options of scalability and the ability of your MFD to last longer
- ✓ Keep in mind the maintenance and running cost of the unit
- ✓ End users should look for features such as cost, size and total cost of the consumables
- ✓ Enterprises should look at the ROI, cost per print, maintenance and ability to share over the network feature
- ✓ Also important are good duty cycle and a robust design

duced first time in a A4/Legal size MFP."

Samsung is also looking to enhance its Print Language—Samsung Printer Language (SPL) so as to minimise hardware requirement such as memory and high speed processor at the printer level and maximise productivity of the printer.

"Features such as Network Scanning, Scan to E-mail Direct will be introduced in the mid range MFPs (Rs 40,000 to Rs 60,000 machines). Wi-Fi Network Connectivity are also in the offing in mid- and high-end models being introduced from Q1 2005 onwards," says Negi.

Rajiv Singh, senior manager, product marketing, Canon India, says, "We plan to introduce auto-duplexing, two-way printing, USB 2.0 USB, compliance between speed and printing etc. We will also be introducing new technology system RAMs which will not be PC dependant."

What The Customers Want

Customers still make the rules. Here's what a few have to say. Anant Gupta owns a publishing house and owns an HP Inkjet MFD. "I purchased this unit around two years back and it is still enough for my needs. I would nevertheless like to see an improvement on the data transmission speed front. The one that I have currently is not good enough."



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